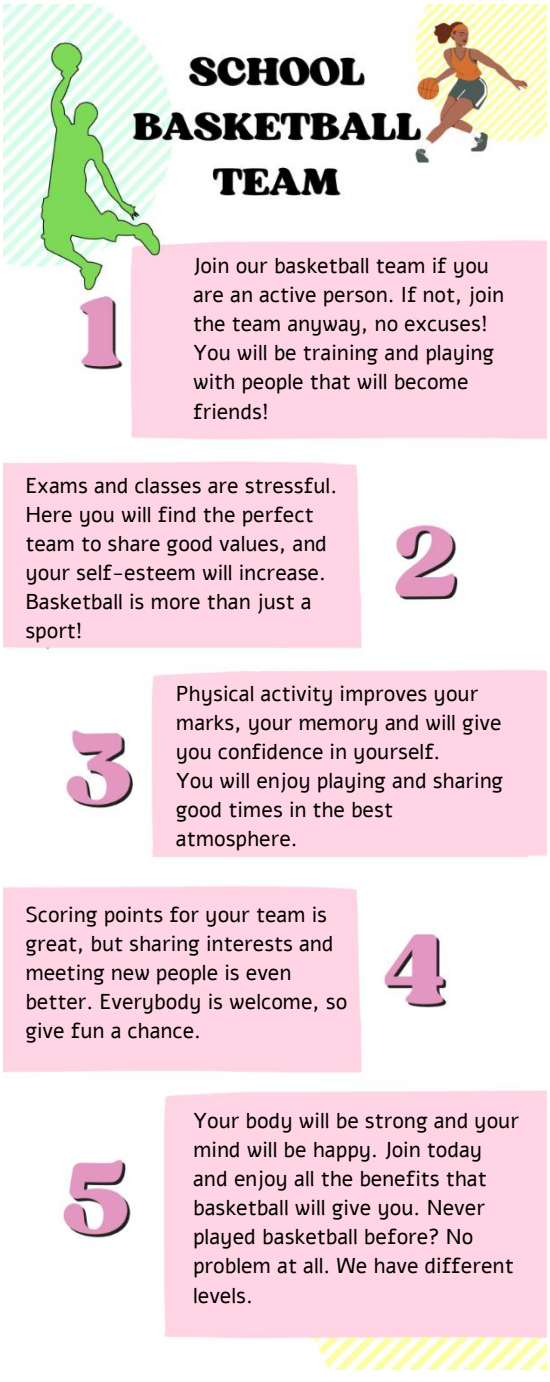
A2 - Oral Mediation 3: Teacher's Notes

Before starting the mediation activity, ask students to read the task and the poster carefully to make the aim of the activity clear.

Join our team!

There is a new student in your class. Her name is Anne, and she comes from Ireland. Anne doesn´t have any friends yet and she is very shy. You start talking to her and you show her all the facilities of the school. You tell Ann that joining the school's basketball team is a great idea for making friends and for some physical exercise. She likes sport, but she has never played basketball before. You are part of the team, so you explain to her what the benefits are. She will do physical exercise and be less stressed. She will be able to meet new people that will become friends to talk to. She will also share good experiences in a nice atmosphere. You want her to know that joining the basketball team she will give her good chance to have a great time at school. Today is the last day to join the team. You talk to her in the break between two classes.



You have ten minutes to prepare the task. You have to tell Anne about the basketball team and the good time she will have if she joins. Tell her about the benefits of training. Talk to her for between 2 to 3 minutes to give her as much information as possible.



In oral mediation, you need to be clear and provide useful information to the listener. The language that you use can be colloquial.

Make sure it is clear why you are talking about the topic. Refer to the context.

Refer to the document you have been asked to read, but do not read it aloud. Use the information given in the text.

Let's get ready!

In this section, you will help students to get ready for the task. First of all, they will learn what to do (Analyse the task) and later, they will work on the information (Analyse the information). You can give them the Learning Sequence worksheet to work on.

1. Analyse the task

Tell students they are going to think about the receiver of the message, the reason for the message and the information included. This will help them to use the proper register (formal or informal).

a. Read the task carefully and answer these questions. They will help you choose the register of the mediation task.

   a) Who is going to be talking and who will receive the message? The student talks and Anne will receive the message.

   b) Why does Anne need help? She is a new student and she is shy.

   c) What information does the addressee need? She needs information about the basketball team.

b. After analysing the task, choose the correct answer.

   a) The addresser is the person who *says* / *receives* the message.

   b) In this mediation task, I have to use *formal* / *informal* register.

   c) *Oral* / *Written* language is associated with less formal language.

2. Analyse the information

Now tell students to think about the relevant information on the poster they will have to use.

Read the information in the poster carefully.

   a) What is the important information in the poster that Anne needs?
   Sport is good for your health and will help you make friends.

   b) Underline the ideas that you think can be most effective to convince Anne to join the basketball team.
   Accept all logical answers.

Let's prepare the language!

In this section students will learn structures and language suitable for the task.

1. Discuss advantages and benefits

1. Read this text where a person explains the benefits of doing sports. Underline all the adjectives that are positive in blue and underline the negative ones in red.

Doing sport is a great way to keep fit. Your bones will become stronger and your muscles more flexible. There are also other excellent reasons to exercise your body: if you are stressed, sport can help you to be calm. Physical activity helps your brain by producing hormones that will make you feel happy and increase your self-esteem. This contributes to a better relationship with yourself and with others.
If you are feeling lonely, try a team sport. The values that you will learn will become part of your life. You will see that you have a lot in common with interesting people who will become friends. When you are tired after a long day at school, doing sport will boost your energy and give you a break from routines. Concentration also gets better if you are not sedentary. You will improve your exam results. The benefits have been studied, and the results tell us that we all should do sport. There is no doubt that you will be healthier.

Other Useful Language

However, …
What is more, …
By the way, …
Nevertheless, …
In addition, …
Similarly, …



Do not use the same expressions all the time. Add new words to your vocabulary and you will see that you express yourself a lot better.

2. Fill in the gaps using adjectives from the text. You will need to use three positive adjectives and three negative adjectives.

Positive adjectives:

a) I love reading novels because the plots are very interesting.
b) Marina is very fit because she goes to the gym three times a week.
c) Doctors say that babies feel very calm when they listen to classical music.

Negative adjectives:

a) I feel very lonely when I don´t have my friends with me.
b) Being stressed is normal when you have a lot of exams.
c) A sedentary life can affect your health in a very bad way.

3. Which of the following expressions are used to express facts and which are used to express opinions?

I think that	It has been established that	In fact	I believe that

FACT	OPINION
It has been established that	I think that
In fact	I believe that

2. Give reasons and examples

1. Give a reason and an example that support each of the statements below.

a) There are many reasons why doing sport has benefits for you.
It will improve your self-esteem, you will make friends and you will have fun.

b) Team sports will help you make friends.
By playing a team sport, you will share common interests with the other players.

Let's mediate!

Make sure students understand the task and you can summarise the tips below.

There is a new student in your class. Her name is Anne, and she comes from Ireland. Anne doesn´t have any friends yet and she is very shy. You start talking to her and you show her all the facilities of the school. You tell Ann that joining the school's basketball team is a great idea for making friends and for some physical exercise. She likes sport, but she has never played basketball before. You are part of the team, so you explain to her what the benefits are. She will do physical exercise and be less stressed. She will be able to meet new people that will become friends to talk to. She will also share good experiences in a nice atmosphere. You want her to know that joining the basketball team she will give her good chance to have a great time at school. Today is the last day to join the team. You talk to her in the break between two classes.

1. Content

Content

Look at the poster on page 1 and read the information there carefully again. Select the information you are going to tell Anne. You can use the following questions:

- How will joining the basketball team help Anne make friends?
  She will meet some students from the new school and interact with them.
- Why should you talk to Anne about sport?
  Because it is good for the body and the mind. It keeps you healthy and helps you socialise.

2. Language

Language

Use your own words. Simplify or paraphrase the information.

Remember to adapt your register to the task and addressee.

Vary the language you use. Look at the Other Useful Language on page 3.

Refer students to the task again and tell them to pay special attention to the Quick Tip. Make sure that the students read the rubric, so that they know what is important.

Let's evaluate!
Rubrics for assessment

Oral Mediation

	Excellent	Good	Acceptable	Unsuitable
Clarity	The information is clear and easy to follow. The main points are clear.	The information is clear to follow but sometimes it is not easy to understand what the main points are.	Some of the information selected is not relevant, lacks coherence and may include contradictions.	The information selected is not relevant, not clear, not easy to follow and includes contradictions.
Relevancy and processing	The student has summarised and paraphrased the main ideas without copying literally. No information has been added.	The student has summarised the main ideas but has not paraphrased them. No information has been added.	The student conveys some appropriate information by summarising the main ideas, but not all.	The student doesn't convey much appropriate information or has copied it from the text. Extra information may have been added.
Flow	The student speaks confidently without many pauses. The speech is fluent.	The student mostly speaks confidently without many pauses. The speech is fluent.	The student speaks confidently part of the time with several pauses. The speech is not always fluent.	The student doesn't speak confidently and often pauses. The speech is not fluent.
Vocabulary	The student uses a wide rage of appropriate vocabulary.	The student mostly uses appropriate and varied vocabulary.	The student uses appropriate vocabulary but it is not varied.	The student doesn't use varied vocabulary or is not able to paraphrase.
Grammar	The student uses a wide range of correct grammatical structures.	The student uses a wide range of grammatical structures but not always correctly.	The student uses basic but correct grammatical structures.	The student uses basic grammatical structures but not always correctly.
Pronunciation and intonation	The student uses understandable pronunciation and intonation.	The student mostly uses understandable pronunciation and intonation.	The student uses understandable pronunciation and intonation with a strong foreign accent.	The student doesn't use understandable pronunciation and intonation.